

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent team-working skills to manage staff in a high-pressure kitchen environment.



Creativity and imagination to devise unique and delicious dishes and keep the menu fresh.



Strong interpersonal skills to maintain good relationships with staff at all levels, as well as diners.



The ability to calculate quantities, price differences, and catering costs to run a profitable kitchen.



Well-honed practical skills and the ability to use kitchen equipment with ease and speed.



CONTRACT CATERING MANAGER Provides catering services to clients for business functions and special events.



INSTITUTIONAL COOK Cooks in the kitchen of a large organization. Employers include the armed services, health providers, factories, and other workplaces.



In the US, more than 13 million people are employed in the restaurant industry.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **BAKER** Produces bread and confectionery products within a manufacturing operation, retail outlet, or restaurant.
- ▶ **BAR OWNER/PROPRIETOR** Runs premises, such as a pub or bar, that serve a variety of beverages. They may also consider branching out into catering or food operations.
- ▶ **FOOD-PROCESSING OPERATIVE** Works on factory production lines, overseeing the mixing, cooking, and packing of food products.
- ▶ **KITCHEN ASSISTANT** Performs basic tasks from food preparation and checking deliveries to cleaning the kitchen and all the equipment.

AT A GLANCE



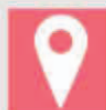
YOUR INTERESTS Food • Cooking • Business administration • Catering, hospitality, and tourism • Food production and farming



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree is not required to become a chef, but food and food production qualifications are an advantage in this industry.



LIFESTYLE Work often starts very early and finishes very late. Split shifts, evenings, and weekends are a normal part of the working cycle.



LOCATION Chefs work mostly in restaurant or hotel kitchens. Catering jobs may involve traveling to locations with cooking equipment.



THE REALITIES Kitchens can be busy high-pressure environments, while equipment, such as knives and hot pans, is potentially dangerous.